

Assessment

Overview of the assessment in the Cambridge National

Qualification title	GLH
OCR Level 1/2 Cambridge National Award in ICT	60

001 and R002.

OCR Level 1/2 Cambridge National Certificate in ICT	120
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001 and R002
over two units.

For details below:

<i>Understanding computer systems</i>	
on paper 0 UMS) d marked	This question paper: - is based on a pre-release - consists of two sections, each with short answer and extended questions.
<i>Using ICT to create solutions in a business environment</i>	
ssed tasks (OCR set) 0 UMS) ssed and OCR-moderated	The assessment for this unit: - is an OCR set task - assesses the quality of written communication.
<i>Handling data using spreadsheets</i>	
ssed tasks 0 UMS) ssed and OCR-moderated	The assessment for this unit: - is an OCR set task - assesses the quality of written communication.
<i>Handling data using databases</i>	
ssed tasks 0 UMS) ssed and OCR-moderated	The assessment for this unit: - is an OCR set task - assesses the quality of written communication.
<i>Creating an interactive product using multimedia components</i>	
ssed tasks 0 UMS) ssed and OCR-moderated	The assessment for this unit: - is an OCR set task - assesses the quality of written communication.
<i>Creating digital images</i>	
	The assessment for this unit:

30 GLH
Centre-assessed tasks
60 marks (60 UMS)
Centre-assessed and OCR-moderated

The assessment for this unit:

- is an OCR set task
- assesses the quality of written communication.

Unit R001 is a timetabled exam. The question paper is based on a pre-release case study. It consists of two sections, each comprising short answer and extended response questions.

Units R002–R007 are centre-assessed and OCR-moderated tasks. These units assess the quality of written communication (QWC). To claim the Level 1/2 Cambridge National Award (60 GLH) qualification learners must complete both Unit R001 and Unit R002.

3.2 Synoptic assessment

This qualification is designed to provide evidence of synoptic assessment that demonstrates pupils' broad understanding of what they have studied in their courses.

It has been written in a way that allows learners to sequentially build up their knowledge, understanding and skills between the mandatory units (R001 and R002) and their chosen optional units over the course of their programme of learning, which will support them in the assessment of their mandatory and optional units.

While we do not prescribe in which order the units are assessed, it is important to be aware of the links between units and the requirement for synoptic assessment so that the teaching, learning and assessment can be planned accordingly. Then when being assessed learners can apply their learning in ways which show they are able to make connections across the qualification.

Synoptic assessment is included in units R003–R007.

This specification will support synoptic assessment by:

- showing teaching and learning links between the units across the specification
- giving guidance, with the marking criteria for the optional units, about where learners could apply the knowledge and understanding from the core units to improve their performance.

This qualification supports synoptic learning and assessment by employing the following principles:

- to enable learners to follow specialist pathways within their optional units allowing for holistic delivery and the application of prior or concurrent learning
- to develop learners' appreciation of how different situations or user needs may contribute to different uses and applications of technology
- to enable learners to demonstrate an ability to use and apply a range of different methods and/or techniques
- to provide assessment that encourages learners to put forward different ideas and/or explanations to support decisions they have made

- to develop learners' ability to suggest or apply different approaches to contexts, situations
- to develop and assess learners' use of transferable skills
- to enable learners to demonstrate analytical and interpretation skills (of situations and/or results) and the ability to formulate valid well-argued responses
- to enable learners to evaluate and justify their decisions, choices and recommendations.

3.3 Grading and awarding grades

All results are awarded on the following scale:

- Distinction* at Level 2 (*2)
- Distinction at Level 2 (D2)
- Merit at Level 2 (M2)
- Pass at Level 2 (P2)
- Distinction at Level 1 (D1)
- Merit at Level 1 (M1)
- Pass at Level 1 (P1).

The shortened format of the grade will be displayed on Interchange and some administrative documents provided by OCR. However, the full format of the grade will appear on certificates issued to learners.

The boundaries for Distinction at Level 2, Pass at Level 2 and Pass at Level 1 are set judgementally. Other grade boundaries are set arithmetically.

The Merit (Level 2) is set at half the distance between the Pass (Level 2) grade and the Distinction (Level 2) grade. Where the gap does not divide equally, the Merit (Level 2) boundary is set at the lower mark (e.g. 45.5 would be rounded down to 45).

The Distinction* (Level 2) grade is normally located as far above Distinction (Level 2) as Merit (Level 2) is below Distinction (Level 2).

To set the Distinction (Level 1) and Merit (Level 1) boundaries, the gap between the Pass (Level 1) grade and the Pass (Level 2) grade is divided by 3, and the boundaries set equidistantly. Where this division leaves a remainder of 1, this extra mark will be added to the Distinction (Level 1)-Pass (Level 2) interval (i.e. the Distinction (Level 1) boundary will be lowered by 1 mark). Where this division leaves a remainder of 2, the extra marks will be added to the Distinction (Level 1)-Pass (Level 2) interval, and the Merit (Level 1)-Distinction (Level 1) interval, i.e. the Distinction (Level 1) boundary will be lowered by 1 mark, and the Merit (Level 1) boundary will be lowered by 1 mark.

For example, if Pass (Level 2) is set judgementally at 59, and Pass (Level 1) is set judgementally at 30, then Distinction (Level 1) is set at 49, and Merit (Level 1) is set at 39.

Grades are indicated on qualification certificates. However, results for learners who fail to achieve the minimum grade (Pass at Level 1) will be recorded as *unclassified* (U or u) and this is **not** certificated.

These qualifications are unitised schemes. Learners can take units across several different series. They can also re-sit units or choose from optional units available. Please refer to section 7.3 *Unit and qualification re-sits*. Grade boundaries are set per unit, per series. As such, grade boundaries

different places for a unit in different series. When working out learners' overall marks, it needs to be able to compare performance on the same unit in different series where boundaries have been set, and between different units. OCR uses a Uniform Mark Scale to do this to be done.

The uniform mark for each unit is calculated from the learner's raw mark on that unit. The raw marks are converted to the equivalent uniform mark boundary. Marks between boundaries are converted on a pro rata basis.

When results are issued, the learner's unit grade and uniform mark are given. The uniform mark is out of the maximum uniform mark for the unit, e.g. 40/60.

The uniform mark boundaries for each of the assessments are shown below:

Unit Uniform Mark	Unit Grade						
	Distinction* at L2	Distinction at L2	Merit at L2	Pass at L2	Distinction at L1	Merit at L1	Pass at L1
60	54	48	42	36	30	24	18

The uniform mark for Unit R001 will be combined with the uniform mark for the centre to give a total uniform mark for the qualification. The learner's overall grade will be based on the total uniform mark. The following table shows the minimum total mark for each grade.

Max Uniform Mark	Qualification Grade						
	Distinction* at L2	Distinction at L2	Merit at L2	Pass at L2	Distinction at L1	Merit at L1	Pass at L1
120	108	96	84	72	60	48	36
240	216	192	168	144	120	96	72

Performance descriptors

The performance descriptors indicate the level of attainment associated with Distinction at Level 2, Merit at Level 2 and Pass at Level 1. They are for use at awarding meetings. They give a general idea of the levels of attainment likely to be shown by a representative learner performing at that level.

Performance descriptor – Distinction at Level 2

able to work with confident independence to create material which reflects a high level of understanding, skilled development and perceptive evaluation.

able to apply knowledge, understanding and skills in a variety of contexts – exploring, analysing and using a range of ICT tools, hardware and file types efficiently to produce effective solutions. They will be able to use confidently a range of features from a variety of software applications that add value in the workplace and in higher education.

able to produce work that is complete and coherent, demonstrating originality and high standards of presentation.

They will be able to:

- recall a wide range of information regarding the effective use of ICT
- perceptively analyse ICT problems
- create solutions which demonstrate detailed consideration of audience and fitness for purpose
- understand and use a wide range of ICT terminology correctly
- use techniques efficiently to search for, select and store appropriate information effectively, in a wide variety of contexts
- model situations, interpret and present information with sensitivity to needs and with a flair for effective communication
- perceptively evaluate the impact of ICT
- demonstrate, in depth, research, analytical and evaluative skills
- work independently and manage time efficiently.

Performance descriptor – Pass at Level 2

Learners will be able to work with independence to create material which reflects effective planning, development and evaluation.

They will be able to apply knowledge, understanding and skills – identifying, selecting and using a range of ICT tools, hardware and file types to produce ICT-based solutions. They will be able to use appropriate features from a range of applications commonly used in the workplace and in higher education.

They will be able to produce work that is complete and coherent, demonstrating independence and understanding.

They will be able to:

- recall information regarding the effective use of ICT
- analyse ICT problems
- create solutions which demonstrate consideration of audience and fitness for purpose
- understand and use ICT terminology correctly
- use techniques to search for select and store appropriate information in a variety of contexts
- model situations, interpret and present information with an understanding of needs and effective communication
- evaluate the impact of ICT
- demonstrate research, analytical and evaluative skills
- work independently and manage time.

Performance descriptor – Pass at Level 1

They will be able to apply knowledge, understanding and skills in a limited range of contexts. They will have understanding of how to identify, select and use ICT tools, hardware and file types to produce ICT-based solutions. They will be able to use a limited range of features from a range of applications commonly used in the workplace and in higher education.

They will be able to produce work which demonstrates some evidence of independence and understanding.

They will be able to:

- recall some information regarding the effective use of ICT
- demonstrate an understanding of ICT problems
- create solutions which demonstrate awareness of audience and fitness for purpose
- understand and use ICT terminology correctly
- use techniques to search for, select and store information
- model situations and present information with an understanding of needs
- understand the impact of ICT
- demonstrate some research and evaluative skills
- state some advantages or disadvantages.

3.5 Quality of written communication

Quality of written communication is assessed in all centre-assessed units and is integrated in the marking criteria.

Learners are expected to:

- ensure that text is legible and that spelling, punctuation and grammar are accurate so that meaning is clear
- present information in a form that suits its purpose
- use a suitable structure and style of writing
- use specialist terminology, where applicable.